

# Tusla Compliance Policy Bundle

## CHILDREN FIRST ACT 2015 — CHILD PROTECTION FRAMEWORK

### 1 PURPOSE & SCOPE

To ensure all children in our care are protected from harm, abuse, and neglect. Applies to all staff, volunteers, contractors, and any person working on behalf of the organisation who may come into contact with children.

### 2 DEFINITIONS & RECOGNISING ABUSE

- ✓ **Child:** Person under the age of 18
- ✓ **DLP:** Designated Liaison Person — receives and acts on child protection concerns
- ✓ **Physical abuse:** Unexplained injuries, marks, bruising
- ✓ **Emotional abuse:** Withdrawn or fearful behaviour, low self-esteem
- ✓ **Sexual abuse:** Age-inappropriate sexual behaviour or knowledge
- ✓ **Neglect:** Inadequate hygiene, clothing, food, or supervision

### 3 REPORTING PROCEDURE

- ✓ **STEP 1** Staff member informs DLP immediately
- ✓ **STEP 2** DLP completes Child Protection and Welfare Report Form
- ✓ **STEP 3** Report submitted to Tusla via Portal or directly
- ✓ **STEP 4** DLP follows up and records outcomes
- ✓ **EMERGENCY** Contact Gardaí directly if child is at immediate risk

### 4 ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

#### All Staff:

- ✓ Must report concerns immediately to the DLP
- ✓ Must complete mandatory child protection training (Children First E-Learning + annual refresher)

#### DLP:

- ✓ Maintains records of all concerns; liaises with Tusla and An Garda Síochána
- ✓ Ensures follow-up and protection measures are in place

### 5 RECRUITMENT, CONFIDENTIALITY & RECORDS

- ✓ **Recruitment:** Garda vetting, reference checks, child protection induction for all staff
- ✓ **Confidentiality:** Information shared on need-to-know basis per GDPR and Children First
- ✓ **Records:** All concerns, disclosures, and actions documented and stored securely for 7 years



# Tusla Compliance Policy Bundle

## OPERATIONAL POLICIES & EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

### 6 COMPLAINTS POLICY

- ✓ Children and families can complain verbally, in writing, anonymously, or via advocate
- ✓ All complaints logged and responded to within 10 working days

### 7 ANTI-BULLYING POLICY

- ✓ Zero tolerance; incidents reported to Key Worker and Manager
- ✓ Restorative practice and support plan created; safety plan for victim; reviewed monthly or post-incident

### 8 BEHAVIOUR MANAGEMENT

- ✓ Positive reinforcement, clear boundaries, de-escalation strategies
- ✓ Individual Behaviour Support Plans (BSPs); **no physical punishment under any circumstances**

### 9 MISSING CHILD PROTOCOL

- ✓ **1** Immediate area search by staff
- ✓ **2** Notify Gardaí and parent/guardian
- ✓ **3** Complete Missing Child Report
- ✓ **4** Conduct Return Interview upon recovery; risk assessments updated

### 10 STAFF CODE OF CONDUCT & DATA PROTECTION

- ✓ Maintain professional boundaries; report safeguarding concerns immediately
- ✓ Use respectful, age-appropriate language; no private contact with children outside work
- ✓ Personal data stored securely, accessed on need-to-know basis, retained per GDPR/Tusla guidance

### 11 FIRE DRILL RECORD

Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Time: \_\_\_\_\_ Location: \_\_\_\_\_

Lead Staff: \_\_\_\_\_ Drill Type: ☐ Planned ☐ Surprise

Response Time: \_\_\_\_\_ min | Issues: \_\_\_\_\_

Corrective Actions: \_\_\_\_\_

Staff Present: \_\_\_\_\_ Residents: \_\_\_\_\_

Lead Staff Signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Manager: \_\_\_\_\_

### 12 POLICY REVIEW LOG

Policy Title: \_\_\_\_\_ Last Reviewed: \_\_\_\_\_

Next Review Due: \_\_\_\_\_ Reviewed By: \_\_\_\_\_

Manager Sign-Off: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_